

Word family: **overlook / overlooks / overlooked / overlooking**

Base word: overlook

Part of speech: mainly **verb**, also **noun** in some varieties of English

Related forms:

* **overlook** (v.) — 忽略；沒有注意到；寬恕 / 不追究；俯瞰

* **overlooked** (adj./participle) — 被忽略的；未受注意的

* **overlooking** (participle/adj.) — 俯瞰.....的；忽略中的

* **overlook** (n., especially AmE) — 觀景台；瞭望點

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **overlook a detail**

* **overlook a mistake**

* **overlook an important fact**

* **overlook a possibility**

* **overlook someone's contribution**

* **often overlooked**

* **easily overlooked**

* **an overlooked problem**

* **an overlooked factor**

* **overlook an offence**

* **overlook someone's behaviour**

* **overlook the sea**

* **overlook the city**

* **a room overlooking the garden**

* **a scenic overlook**

Meaning in this passage

> If tasks are vaguely assigned, employees may duplicate work, **overlook crucial details** or proceed in completely different directions.

Here, **overlook** means:

to fail to notice, consider, or deal with something important — 忽略；沒有注意到；漏掉

The employees do not deliberately decide that the details are unimportant. Because communication is unclear, they may simply **fail to notice them or remember to deal with them**.

中文翻譯：

如果任務分配得含糊不清，員工可能會重複工作、**忽略重要細節**，或者各自朝完全不同的方向進行。

So here:

overlook crucial details = 因疏忽或沒有留意，而漏掉重要細節

1. **overlook something (沒有注意到；忽略) — 忽略；漏掉**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Employees may **overlook crucial details**.

員工可能會**忽略重要細節**。

Practice 2

> In a rushed meeting, it is easy to **overlook important information**.

在匆忙的會議中，很容易**漏掉重要資料**。

Practice 3

> The team **overlooked a small but significant error**.

團隊**沒有注意到一個細小但重要的錯誤**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overlook = 沒有注意、考慮或處理某件本應注意的事情****

2. **overlook a detail — 忽略 / 漏掉細節**

A very common collocation.

Practice 1

> We **overlooked one important detail** in the schedule.

我們在時間表中**漏掉了一個重要細節**。

Practice 2

> Careful checking helps prevent people from **overlooking details**.

仔細檢查有助避免人們**忽略細節**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook a detail = 沒有注意到某個細節，尤其是本來應該發現的

3. **overlook a mistake / error** — 沒有發現錯誤

Practice 1

> The editor **overlooked several spelling mistakes**.

編輯**漏掉了幾個串字錯誤**。

Practice 2

> Even experienced workers can **overlook errors** when they are tired.

即使有經驗的員工疲倦時也可能**沒有察覺錯誤**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook an error = 檢查時沒有發現某個錯誤

4. **overlook a fact** — 忽略某項事實

Practice 1

> The report **overlooks an important fact**.

報告**忽略了一項重要事實**。

Practice 2

> We should not **overlook the fact that different departments have different priorities**.

我們不應**忽略不同部門有不同優先事項這個事實**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook a fact = 分析或思考時沒有充分注意某項事實

5. **overlook a possibility** — 沒有考慮某種可能性

Practice 1

> Investigators initially **overlooked the possibility of human error**.

調查人員最初**沒有考慮人為錯誤這個可能性**。

Practice 2

> Don't **overlook the possibility that both sides misunderstood the instructions**.

不要**忽略雙方都誤解了指示這個可能性**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook a possibility = 沒有想到或考慮某種可能性

6. **overlook a problem / issue** — 沒有注意 / 處理問題

Practice 1

> Managers cannot afford to **overlook communication problems**.

管理人員不能**忽視溝通問題**。

Practice 2

> The organisation had **overlooked the issue for years**.

該機構多年來一直**沒有正視這個問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook a problem = 沒有察覺或沒有給予問題應有的注意

Depending on context, this can shade toward deliberate ignoring, so check the surrounding sentence.

7. **overlook someone's contribution** — 忽略某人的貢獻

Practice 1

> Managers should not **overlook the contributions of quieter employees**.

管理人員不應**忽略較安靜員工的貢獻**。

Practice 2

> Her work was repeatedly **overlooked**.

她的工作一再**沒有得到應有的注意 / 認可**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook someone's contribution = 沒有注意、重視或認可某人的付出

8. **overlook someone for promotion / recognition — 忽略某人，沒有給予機會或認可**

A useful workplace extension.

Practice 1

> She was **overlooked for promotion** despite her strong performance.

儘管她表現出色，晉升時卻**沒有被考慮 / 被忽略了**。

Practice 2

> Talented junior staff are sometimes **overlooked**.

有才能的初級員工有時會**被忽略**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook someone = 在給予機會、認可或選擇時沒有注意或考慮到某人

9. **often / frequently overlooked — 經常被忽略**

Practice 1

> Emotional intelligence is an **often overlooked** part of teamwork.

情緒智商是團隊合作中一個**經常被忽略的部分**。

Practice 2

> One frequently **overlooked factor** is workload distribution.

一個經常**被忽略的因素**是工作量分配。

MCQ-ready definition:

often overlooked = 雖然重要，但人們經常沒有注意或重視

10. **easily overlooked** — 很容易被忽略

Practice 1

> Small communication problems are **easily overlooked**.

細小的溝通問題**很容易被忽略**。

Practice 2

> The warning sign is **easy to overlook**.

這個警告標誌**很容易被漏看**。

MCQ-ready definition:

easily overlooked = 因不明顯、細小或注意力不足而容易沒有被發現

11. **an overlooked issue / factor** — 被忽略的問題 / 因素

Practice 1

> Workload fairness is an **overlooked issue** in some teams.

工作量公平性在某些團隊中是一個**被忽視的問題**。

Practice 2

> Communication style is an **overlooked factor** in workplace conflict.

溝通方式是職場衝突中一個**經常未受重視的因素**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlooked = 沒有得到足夠注意、考慮或認可的

12. **overlook something (故意不追究) — 寬恕；不計較；不追究**

This is a second major verb sense.

Here, the speaker **does notice the problem**, but chooses not to act on it.

Practice 1

> I'll **overlook the mistake this time**.

這次我會**不追究這個錯誤**。

Practice 2

> The manager was willing to **overlook his lateness on this occasion**.

經理願意在這一次**不追究他遲到的問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook = 明知某個錯誤或問題存在，但選擇不責備、不懲罰或不追究

13. **overlook a minor offence / fault — 不追究小過失**

Practice 1

> The teacher decided to **overlook the minor offence**.

老師決定**不追究這個小過失**。

Practice 2

> We can **overlook a small mistake**, but repeated errors are different.

小錯我們可以**不計較**，但一再犯錯就不同。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook a fault/offence = 發現了過失，但選擇寬容、不作處分

14. **overlook someone's behaviour — 對某人的行為不追究**

Practice 1

> Management should not simply **overlook repeated misconduct**.

管理層不應只是**對一再出現的不當行為置之不理**。

Practice 2

> His behaviour was too serious to **overlook**.

他的行為太嚴重，不能**不追究**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook behaviour = 明知某種行為有問題，但選擇不採取行動

15. **overlook (俯瞰；面向) — 俯瞰；從高處望向**

A completely separate major sense.

Practice 1

> The hotel **overlooks the sea**.

酒店**俯瞰大海**。

Practice 2

> Our office **overlooks the city centre**.

我們的辦公室**俯瞰市中心**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook a place = 位於較高或適當的位置，可以望到某地方

16. **a room overlooking something — 一個面向 / 俯瞰某景色的房間**

Practice 1

> We booked a room **overlooking the harbour**.

我們訂了一間**可俯瞰海港的房間**。

Practice 2

> Her office has a window **overlooking the garden**.

她的辦公室有一扇窗**面向花園**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlooking X = 位於可以直接望見 X 的位置

17. **overlook the valley / river / park — 俯瞰山谷 / 河流 / 公園**

Practice 1

> The house sits on a hill **overlooking the valley**.

房子坐落在山上，**俯瞰山谷**。

Practice 2

> The restaurant **overlooks the river**.

餐廳**面向並俯瞰河流**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overlook a landscape = 從較高或開揚位置望向一片景物

18. **overlook (noun, especially AmE : 觀景台 / 瞭望點) — 觀景台 ; 觀景點**

A modern noun sense, especially in North American English.

Practice 1

> We stopped at a scenic **overlook** to take photographs.

我們在一個風景優美的**觀景點**停下來拍照。

Practice 2

> The trail leads to an **overlook** above the valley.

這條小徑通往山谷上方的一個**瞭望點**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****an overlook = especially AmE: 設於高處、供人觀賞景色的地方****

19. ****scenic overlook — 風景觀景點****

Practice 1

> There is a ****scenic overlook**** beside the road.

道路旁有一個****風景觀景點****。

Practice 2

> The scenic ****overlook**** offers a wide view of the mountains.

這個****觀景台****可以飽覽群山景色。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****scenic overlook = 專門供人停下來欣賞自然景觀的高處觀景地點****

Important distinction 1: ****overlook vs miss****

This is the biggest distinction for your passage.

****miss****

fail to notice, see, hear, catch, or experience something.

****overlook****

fail to notice something that should probably have received attention.

> I missed the sign.

> 我沒看到標誌。

> The report overlooked an important detail.

> 報告****忽略了一項重要細節****。

****Overlook**** often implies that something important escaped careful attention.

Important distinction 2: **overlook vs ignore**

Extremely important.

overlook

often unintentional:

> I overlooked the mistake.

> 我**沒有注意到**那個錯誤。

But it can also mean deliberately forgive it.

ignore

you notice something but deliberately give it no attention:

> I ignored the warning.

> 我看到警告，但**沒有理會**。

So in your passage:

overlook crucial details = accidentally fail to notice them

not:

deliberately ignore important details

Important distinction 3: **overlook vs neglect**

overlook

fail to notice or consider.

neglect

fail to give proper care, attention, or action over time.

> overlook a detail

> 漏掉細節

> neglect your duties

> 疏忽職責

****Neglect**** often implies failure to fulfil a responsibility.

Important distinction 4: ****overlook vs omit****

****omit****

leave something out of a document, list, speech, etc.

****overlook****

fail to notice or consider it.

> omit a paragraph

> 刪去 / 沒有包括一段

> overlook an important point

> 忽略一個重要觀點

Something can be ****omitted deliberately****; ****overlooked**** often happens unintentionally.

Important distinction 5: ****overlook vs forget****

****forget****

fail to remember something already known.

****overlook****

fail to notice or consider it.

> I forgot the deadline.

> 我忘記了截止日期。

> I overlooked the deadline in the document.

> 我看文件時****漏看了截止日期****。

Important distinction 6: ****overlook vs fail to notice****

These are very close.

fail to notice

plain, explicit description.

overlook

more compact and often slightly more formal.

> We failed to notice the error.

> 我們沒有注意到錯誤。

> We overlooked the error.

> 我們漏掉了錯誤。

Important distinction 7: **overlook vs underestimate**

overlook

fail to notice or consider.

underestimate

notice something, but judge its size, importance, difficulty, etc. as lower than it really is.

> overlook the problem

> 沒注意到問題

> underestimate the problem

> 低估問題

Completely different errors.

Important distinction 8: **overlook vs dismiss**

overlook

may fail to notice, or deliberately not punish.

dismiss

actively decide something is unimportant, untrue, or not worth consideration.

> overlook evidence

> 沒注意證據

> dismiss evidence

> 認為證據不重要而排除

Important distinction 9: **overlook vs forgive**

In the “do not punish” sense:

forgive

stop feeling anger or blame toward a person.

overlook

choose not to make an issue of a particular fault.

> forgive someone for lying

> 原諒某人說謊

> overlook a minor mistake

> 不追究一個小錯

Overlook is often more about the offence than the emotional relationship.

Important distinction 10: **overlook = two almost opposite mental processes**

This is a classic source of confusion.

Sense A:

> I **overlooked** the mistake.

= I **did not notice** it.

Sense B:

> I'll **overlook** the mistake this time.

= I **did notice** it, but I will not punish you for it.

So context tells you whether:

1. the mistake was ****unnoticed****, or
2. the mistake was ****noticed but forgiven****.

Important distinction 11: ****overlook a person****

When a person is ****overlooked****, it often means:

they were not noticed, considered, selected, or properly recognised.

> overlooked for promotion

> 晉升時被忽略

It does ****not**** usually mean physically “look over the top of the person”.

Important distinction 12: ****overlook vs look over****

These are completely different.

****overlook****

> overlook a detail

> 忽略細節

****look over****

> look over the report

> 快速查看 / 檢查報告

Compare:

> I ****looked over**** the report but ****overlooked**** one error.

我****檢查了****報告，但****漏掉了****一個錯誤。

Excellent learner contrast.

Important distinction 13: ****overlook vs oversee****

These are easy to confuse.

overlook

= fail to notice / forgive / have a view over

oversee

= supervise

> overlook a mistake

> 忽略錯誤

> oversee a project

> 監督項目

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction 14: **overlook vs supervise**

Modern standard English normally uses:

> supervise workers

> oversee workers

for **監督員工**.

Using **overlook** to mean “supervise” is not a useful modern general learner sense, so it should not be learned as the normal meaning.

Important distinction 15: **overlook = view sense vs ignore sense**

Compare:

> The hotel **overlooks the harbour**.

> 酒店**俯瞰海港**。

> The report **overlooks an important issue**.

> 報告**忽略了一個重要問題**。

Same spelling, entirely different semantic branches.

Important distinction 16: ****overlooking as a participle****

Compare:

View:

- > a balcony ****overlooking the sea****
- > 一個****面向大海****的露台

Neglect:

- > By ****overlooking these details****, the team created more problems.
- > 由於****忽略這些細節****，團隊造成了更多問題。

Again, context determines the sense.

Important distinction 17: ****overlooked = unnoticed vs undervalued****

Unnoticed:

- > an overlooked spelling error
- > 被漏看的串字錯誤

Undervalued / insufficiently considered:

- > an overlooked employee
- > 沒有得到應有注意或認可的員工

The second often involves social or professional recognition.

Important distinction 18: ****overlook vs leave out****

****leave out****

do not include.

****overlook****

do not notice or consider.

> The writer left out the final example.

> 作者沒有包括最後一個例子。

> The writer overlooked an important argument.

> 作者忽略了一個重要論點。

Important distinction 19: **overlook in your passage**

The writer says:

> employees may **duplicate work, overlook crucial details or proceed in completely different directions**

These are all consequences of unclear task assignment.

So **overlook** here is clearly:

unintentional failure to notice or deal with an important detail

It does **not** mean:

- * forgive the detail,
- * deliberately ignore it,
- * look down on it physically.

Family-extension note

Overlook has three major modern verb branches:

1. **fail to notice or consider**

- * overlook a detail
- * overlook a problem
- * overlooked contribution

2. **notice but choose not to punish**

- * overlook a minor mistake
- * overlook an offence

3. **have a view over**

- * overlook the sea
- * room overlooking the garden

And one established noun branch, especially AmE:

4. **viewpoint**

- * scenic overlook

For your passage, the exact branch is:

overlook = unintentionally fail to notice or consider something important

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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overlook (fail to notice)	忽略；漏掉	not notice	
overlook a detail	忽略細節	missed detail	
overlook an error	沒發現錯誤	missed error	
overlook a fact	忽略事實	missed consideration	
overlook a possibility	沒考慮可能性	missed option	
overlook a problem	忽略問題	insufficient attention	
overlook someone's contribution	忽略某人的貢獻	recognition	
be overlooked for promotion	晉升時被忽略	not considered	
often overlooked	經常被忽略	insufficient attention	
easily overlooked	容易被忽略	hard to notice	
overlooked issue	被忽略的問題	neglected consideration	
overlook (forgive)	不追究；寬容	notice but excuse	
overlook a minor mistake	不追究小錯	forgive fault	
overlook misconduct	不追究不當行為	tolerate	
overlook (view)	俯瞰；面向	have view over	
overlook the sea	俯瞰大海	location/view	
room overlooking the garden	面向花園的房間	view	
overlook (noun)	觀景台；觀景點	viewpoint	
scenic overlook	風景觀景點	AmE viewpoint	

For your original sentence

> If tasks are vaguely assigned, employees may duplicate work, **overlook crucial details** or proceed in completely different directions.

Here:

****overlook crucial details = 因任務和責任界線不清，員工可能沒有注意到某些本來應該處理的重要細節，結果這些細節被漏掉****

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 如果任務分配得含糊不清，員工可能會重複工作、****忽略重要細節****，或者各自朝完全不同的方向進行。

The cleanest contrast is:

- > ****miss**** = 沒看到 / 沒留意，最廣泛
- > ****forget**** = 忘記原本知道的事
- > ****omit**** = 沒有把某東西包括進去
- > ****ignore**** = ****知道它存在但故意不理****
- > ****neglect**** = 長期沒有給予應有照顧 / 注意
- > ****overlook**** = ****本來應該注意到，卻因疏忽而漏掉****

And one especially useful pair to remember is:

- > ****look over a report**** = 查看 / 檢查報告
- > ****overlook an error**** = ****檢查時漏掉一個錯誤****

For your passage, that accidental ****failure of attention**** is exactly the intended meaning.